



THAT FRIEND

GENRE

Comedy / Bromance

RUNTIME

90 min

PRODUCTION

Bolo / Straw Hut Media

IMDB

tt33041195

Logline

When Paul crashes his best friend Henry's romantic weekend in Palm Springs with his new girlfriend Penny, what starts as an innocent visit spirals into mayhem after Paul's drug-laced cigarettes disappear into a stranger's hands.

Synopsis

That Friend is an indie bromance comedy about Paul (Harvey Guillén) — you know, that friend whose invitation for “one drink” seems harmless but inevitably leads to chaotic consequences.

When Paul crashes his best friend Henry's (Josh Brener) romantic weekend in Palm Springs with his new girlfriend Penny (Billie Lourd), what starts as an innocent visit spirals into mayhem after Paul's drug-laced cigarettes disappear into a stranger's hands.

Written and directed by the filmmaking duo Alex Wall and Will Sterling in their feature debut, this film explores the hilarious and complex dynamics of friendship, loyalty, and the chaos we create for the people we love most.



Directors' Statement

At its core, *That Friend* is about the person in your life who always makes things messier, louder, and more complicated than you wanted, but who you just can't seem to let go of. We've both had those people. In fact, at some point, we've both been those people.

Comedy is often rooted in chaos, but what drew us to this story was the tension beneath the laughs: what do you do when a lifelong friendship that once felt indestructible starts to feel toxic? When it starts getting in the way of the life you want for yourself? How do you separate love from obligation, nostalgia from reality? Those questions gave us a way to explore friendship, love, codependency, and emotional growth, while still letting things spiral into the kind of absurd, drug fueled, wild night level of fun that this story lives in.

We wanted the film to feel like a night out with that friend, unpredictable, hilarious, exhausting, and ultimately revealing of a truth that is almost impossible to acknowledge. The goal wasn't just to capture the hijinks, but to sit in the morning after, the hangover where you wonder if maybe it's time to change.

Making this film together as longtime friends ourselves, we channeled our own histories into the DNA of these characters. *That Friend* is loud and chaotic on the surface, but at its core is a love letter to complicated friendships, the kind that shape us, frustrate us, and, in the end, teach us who we really are.



Filmmakers



Alex Wall

WRITER / DIRECTOR

That Friend is the debut feature from Alex Wall (writer/director). His prior collaborations with Will Sterling have placed and been featured in The Academy Nicholl Fellowships in Screenwriting, Newport Beach Film Festival, Paris International Film Festival, Austin Film Festival, Blue Cat Screenwriting and more. Wall edits and produces unscripted television for HBO, MAX, NBC, A&E and Netflix.



Will Sterling

WRITER / DIRECTOR

"That Friend" is the second feature from writer, director, actor, producer Will Sterling, whose work blends sharp comedy with strong emotional undercurrents and genre driven storytelling. His meta-comedy "A Cell Phone Movie" was nominated for Best Debut Feature at the Raindance Film Festival in 2025, and his debut novel "Fame by Misadventure" won Best Fiction in the 2024 National Indie Excellence Awards.



Ryan Tillotson

PRODUCER

Ryan Tillotson is the founder and CEO of acclaimed podcast house Straw Hut Media that partners with Hulu, Netflix, Universal, Rotten Tomatoes, among several other companies.



Michael Amico

DIRECTOR OF PHOTOGRAPHY

Michael Amico is a Prague-based photographer and cinematographer. With a background in documentary, he focuses on people, observing how individuals behave within different environments and often looking for moments of contrast within a scene. He approaches cinematography with a photographer's mindset—using framing, blocking, and natural light to support performance and reveal character. That Friend is his debut narrative feature film.



Josh Land

EDITOR

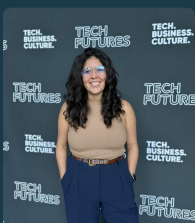
Josh Land is an editor & assistant editor whose work spans studio films, independent features, documentaries, and television. His recent credits include Only, Courage Rising, Transformers: Rise of the Beasts, and Sandiwara, the upcoming short film from Sean Baker.



Dillon Baldassero

COMPOSER

Dillon Baldassero is a Los Angeles-based composer, producer, and artist from Toronto. His recent work includes the SXSW-premiering Deepfaking Sam Altman, The Fallers (Georgina Campbell), and music supervision on A24's The Undertone. He scored the Amazon/Hulu series Davey & Jonesie's Locker, earning a Canadian Screen Award nomination, and has contributed music to the upcoming feature Ballistic (Lena Headey). He is currently scoring Hartbeat's Livestream from Hell, starring Kevin Hart and Druski.



Kristi Lugo

CASTING DIRECTOR

Kristi Lugo is a Los Angeles-based casting director whose recent credits include I Play Rocky, directed by Academy Award-winner Peter Farrelly, and DC's Blue Beetle. She consults for Fangoria Studios and is currently casting The Big Five produced by Coco Francini and Allison Friedman.

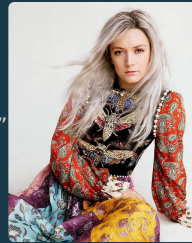
Cast



Harvey Guillén

PAUL

Emmy-nominated for his beloved role as Guillermo in “What We Do in the Shadows.”



Billie Lourd

PENNY

Star of “American Horror Story,” “Scream Queens,” and “Booksmart.”



Josh Brener

HENRY

Known for “Silicon Valley” and “The Internship.”



Retta

CHRISTINE

Known for “Parks and Recreation” and “Good Girls.”



Neil Brown Jr.

BILL

Known for “SEAL Team” and “Straight Outta Compton.”



Miles Gutierrez-Riley

SPENCER

Known for “The Wilds” and “Gaslit.”



Lauren Lapkus

JESSA

Known for “Orange Is the New Black,” “The Wrong Missy,” and “Good Girls.”



Mary Holland

MICHELLE

Known for “Happiest Season,” “Booksmart,” and “The Afterparty.”



Rose Abdoo

MARYANN

Known for “Gilmore Girls,” “Reno 911!,” and “People of Earth.”



Alok Vaid-Menon

BLAIR

Acclaimed author, poet, and performer known for their comedy specials and bestselling books.



Paul Guzman

PHILLIP

Actor and comedian known for his versatile performances.



Will Sterling

PASTOR KEVIN

Co-writer and co-director of “That Friend,” also appearing as Pastor Kevin.

Full Credits

WRITTEN & DIRECTED BY	ALEX WALL & WILL STERLING
PRODUCED BY	RYAN TILLOTSON
EXECUTIVE PRODUCERS	TROY HOFFMAN, LEVI CHAMBERS, STEPHEN MARKLEY
EXECUTIVE PRODUCERS	HARVEY GUILLÉN, BILLIE LOURD, JOSH BRENER, RETTA
PRODUCERS	ALEX WALL & WILL STERLING
CO-PRODUCER	KRISTI LUGO
DIRECTOR OF PHOTOGRAPHY	MICHAEL AMICO
EDITED BY	JOSH LAND
MUSIC BY	DILLON BALDASSERO
PRODUCTION DESIGNER	LUCIA LOPEZ
WARDROBE BY	DANIELLE BAZAN & MADELINE BOREHAM
CASTING DIRECTOR	KRISTI LUGO
1ST ASSISTANT DIRECTOR	ASHLEY ROSENBERG

Cast

PAUL	HARVEY GUILLÉN
PENNY	BILLIE LOURD
HENRY	JOSH BRENER
CHRISTINE	RETTA
BILL	NEIL BROWN JR.
SPENCER	MILES GUTIERREZ-RILEY
JESSA	LAUREN LAPKUS
MICHELLE	MARY HOLLAND
MARYANN	ROSE ABDOO
BLAIR	ALOK VAID-MENON
FREDRICK	JIM HOFFMASTER
PASTOR KEVIN	WILL STERLING
PHILLIP	PAUL GUZMAN
CHRIS	ALAN PETERSON
TIFFANY	AISHA HOLDEN
OTHER HENRY	VANCE LOVETT
BABY HENRY	ALEX WALL

Additional Cast

PARTYGOER	KATHARINE MANGOLD
PARTYGOER	EDWARD HONG
PARTYGOER	ANAND RAMPRASAD
PARTYGOER	SOFIANE AÏT-KACI
PARTYGOER	JASE ALAN
PARTYGOER	JOSEPHINE CHANG
BONFIRE GUEST	MADISON CROSS
BONFIRE GUEST	CHRISTINE ARMSTRONG
BONFIRE GUEST	DILLON BALDASSERO
BONFIRE GUEST	MAGGIE BOLES
BONFIRE GUEST	BRIANNA WONGSUPHAKPHAN
LIQUOR STORE CLERK	EDGAR
PAUL'S RIDESHARE DRIVER	ASHLEY ROSENBERG
PENNY'S FOOT	MAGGIE BOLES

Crew

1ST ASSISTANT DIRECTOR	ASHLEY ROSENBERG
SCRIPT SUPERVISOR	KRISTIN RAPINCHUK
PRODUCTION COORDINATOR	VANCE LOVETT
2ND UNIT DP	CAMERON OWEN
CAMERA OPERATORS	ARTURO OCHOA, CAMERON OWEN
1ST CAMERA ASSISTANTS	JAKE O'CONNOR, CECILIA HUBBARD, ANDRE FERNANDEZ
DRONE OPERATOR	MALIN HILES
DIGITAL IMAGING TECH	JOSH LAND
KEY GRIP	LANCE BROWN
2ND UNIT KEY GRIP	KEVIN RAMIREZ
PRODUCTION SOUND MIXER	DANIEL MCCOY
PRODUCTION DESIGNER	LUCIA LOPEZ
WARDROBE	DANIELLE BAZAN, MADELINE BOREHAM
HAIR DEPARTMENT HEAD	JILL CORP
KEY HAIR STYLIST	CONNIE AGAWIN
KEY MAKEUP ARTIST	ROMIE MACEDO
MAKEUP ARTISTS	KEAGHLAN ASHLEY, JAY QUINTANA
PRODUCTION ASSISTANTS	RAELLE VARGAS, BRIANNA WONGSUPHAKPHAN
ASST. TO HARVEY GUILLÉN	AMADA SANCHEZ
BEHIND THE SCENES	EDWARD SANDOVAL, MATT CARVER
SET PHOTOGRAPHER	JORDAN REED
HEAD OF TRANSPORTATION	ERIC DANSAK

Post Production

EDITED BY JOSH LAND
ASSISTANT EDITOR JOSH LAND
COMPOSER DILLON BALDASSERO
MUSIC SUPERVISOR SCARLETT MCDONALD
DIGITAL INTERMEDIATE FOTOKEM CREATIVE SERVICES
FINISHING COLORIST ALASTOR ARNOLD
FINISHING PRODUCER EMILY VAIL
VISUAL EFFECTS BENJAMIN NICHOLS

Sound — MelodyGun Studios

SOUND SUPERVISOR HAMED HOKAMZADEH, MPSE
SUPV. SOUND EDITOR / RE-REC MIXER THOMAS OUZIEL, MPSE
DIALOG EDITOR KEVIN KHOR, MPSE
FOLEY ARTIST REECE MILLER
FOLEY MIXER KRISTOPHER BRECKON
SOUND EFFECTS EDITOR AMENDA LEE

Musicians

TRUMPET KAE MURPHY
FLUTE & CLARINET KAREN NG
DRUMS & PERCUSSION MARK BALLYK
DRUMS ZACH SUTTON
BASS & GUITAR BRAD LABELLE

Catering

ANNA MARIE UGAPO
GWEN MARLOWE CATERING
LEO'S TACOS

Music

“Shake Your Groove Thing”

Peaches & Herb • Courtesy of Polydor Records / Universal Music Enterprises

“It Keeps You Running”

The Doobie Brothers • Courtesy of Rhino Entertainment / Warner Music Group

“It Keeps You Running”

Michael McDonald • Courtesy of Kobalt Music Publishing

“When They Fight, They Fight”

Grant Widmer & Edward Joyner • Rough Trade Publishing / Bank Robber Music

“Time”

Angelo De Augustine • Courtesy of Secretly Publishing / Asthmatic Kitty Records

“I Can't Explain”

Maggie Glass • Produced by Dillon Baldassero

“This Is It”

Maggie Glass • Produced by Dillon Baldassero

“Modern Love”

Maggie Glass

“True Romance”

Maggie Glass • Performed by Squarefish

“I'm That Girl”

Danielle Carr

“MP3”

Danielle Carr

“She Noticed”

Pregnant

“Wyd”

Grebes

“Time With My Baby”

Tino Drima

“Infinito Tren”

Amos Ever Hadani ft. Tula Ben Ari • Courtesy of Artlist

“Where's The Magic Gone”

Kyle Cox • Courtesy of Artlist

“Le Bon Temps”

Retrophonics • Courtesy of Artlist

“Lever De La Lune”

Dan Zeutine feat. Loren Noyman • Courtesy of Artlist

“Limitless ZISO Remix”

Ziso • Courtesy of Artlist

“Harmony Rush”

Alex MakeMusic • Courtesy of Artlist

“Hi”

Kawauso • Courtesy of Artlist

“Miss Lindy”

Larry and The Lamp Lighters • Courtesy of Artlist

“End Of The Line”

Roy Young • Courtesy of Artlist

“Your & I”

Benjamin Esterlis • Courtesy of Artlist

“Positive Persistent Pluck Sequence 2”

Artlist Music Logos • Courtesy of Artlist

Thank You

MICHAEL MCDONALD • KACEY SHORT • TARA ROY • MAGGIE BOLES • MOTHER EARTH BREWING • PIZZA PORT BREWING •
CARVER DISERENS • SONJA O'HARA • JEFF DEVERETT • JAY KOGEN • CAROLINE MENDOZA • ANA CLARA • ALI AHMED •
DANIELLE CARR • MADISON CROSS • ALAN PETERSON • NIKKI GROTON • PAUL COLEMAN • RACHEL PAULSON • KAYLEEN CASEY
• MICHAELANGELO MACIAS • CARRIE FRAZIER • JESSICA THOMPSON • CONNOR SIMPSON • KATRINA BITNER • BENJAMIN
NICHOLS • CHRISTINE ARMSTRONG • STEPHEN MARKLEY • ANAND RAMPRASAD • IAN ROBERTSON • DAVID PERGOLINI •
NICHOLAS YBARRA • JASE ALLEN • KATIE MCCUEN • DAVE BURG • DEAN LIAO • KEAYVA MITCHELL • CHRISTIAN BLADT • XAVIER
MONTESINOS • ALEXANDRA MONTESINOS • KRISTI AVILA • RAJEEV DASSANI • CALIFORNIA STATE UNIVERSITY AT LONG BEACH •
THE WRITERS OF FANTASY FOOTBALL LEAGUE • ADAM MOORE • MARTIN WRIGHT • RYAN BEARDSLEY • MARK HANNA • EMMETT
RUSSELL • JAMES LOSTLEN • GEORGE ZAKKOUR • JENNIFER JAKOB SCELZI • DAVID HOLECHEK • DANIEL HOLECHEK • BEN COX
• ALEXANDER JEFFREY • GREG HOLLANDER • BO YOUNGBLOOD

Tech Specs

COUNTRY OF PRODUCTION — United States

RUNNING TIME — 90 Minutes

ORIGINAL LANGUAGE — English

SHOOTING FORMAT — Digital, Color — Two Arri Alexa Minis

Filmed on Location

Palm Springs, California

San Bernardino County, California

Desert Hot Springs, California

Los Angeles, California

Equipment Provided by

Lightstone Rentals • Bright Orange Productions • Straw Hut Media • Lars Lindstrom • Bokeh Rentals • The Fun Ton Grip and
Lighting • Lance Brown



FOTO KEM



Captured with

ALEXA MINI

Press

BILLIE LOURD JOINS 'THAT FRIEND' COMEDY MOVIE

deadline.com • October 2024

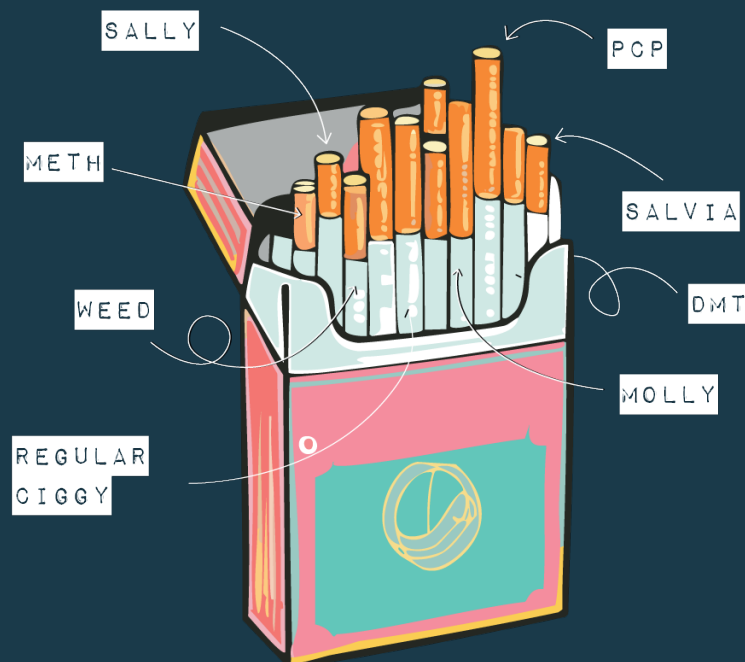
JOSH BRENER JOINS HARVEY GUILLÉN IN 'THAT FRIEND' COMEDY

deadline.com • August 2024

HARVEY GUILLÉN TO TOPLINE 'THAT FRIEND' COMEDY

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The Magical
Mystery
tour



Everyone has...

THAT FRIEND

Contact

A Bolo Production in association with Straw Hut Media

Ryan Tillotson, Producer

ryan@strawhutmedia.com